

Wildcats Women's Tennis

TEAM PROFILE

What the surveys say about the group as a whole. This is not the sum of individuals: a team under pressure behaves differently than each player would alone.

Based on 6 completed surveys out of 8 sent.

Summary for the coach

This section is written to stand on its own. The rest of the report expands and evidences it.

What you can lean on

- Discipline, habits and recovery. The team has its habits under control. This is an area to lean on while harder work goes on elsewhere.
- Confidence and inner dialogue. Confidence is there but it is tied to form. After a good week there is plenty, after a bad one it is gone. The team plays in an amplitude: two rounds above its level, two below it.

Where it is fragile

- Emotion regulation and performance under pressure. This is the most serious shape a team can have. While the match is calm it is invisible; as soon as it matters, the squad divides and the first half stops playing and starts managing the second. The team loses twice.
- Concentration and attention control. Half the team has routines and half has none. The gap shows in the second half of matches and on the later days of a tournament, not in practice.

Where to start

The team divides into two groups in Emotion regulation and performance under pressure. While that lasts there is no point introducing anything squad-wide, because each group needs something different. That is why this comes first. Train under pressure, not with pressure on the result. Time limits, an audience, a consequence for an error, an uneven start. Without that the threshold does not move.

How to read this report

Each area carries two numbers. The level says how high the team sits. The spread says how far apart the players are. As a rule the spread tells you more: two teams at the same level behave completely differently under pressure depending on whether they are even or divided.

We distinguish three shapes of distribution and each is handled differently. An even area can be moved collectively. An area where someone stands apart means one or two players far from the rest; that is a conversation with them, not a team meeting. A divided area means two groups with a gap between them; there a shared solution does not work, because what helps one group hurts the other.

The report never identifies anyone. No names, no labels, no ranking. That is deliberate: the players were promised you would not see their answers, and without that promise they would have answered differently and the data would be worthless.

The numbers are a snapshot, not a verdict. They describe how the squad answered in one week of a season. Areas that come out low are skills, and skills are trained.

WHAT THIS REPORT IS NOT FOR

- It is not a selection tool. Nothing here predicts an individual's performance in a particular match.
- It is not a diagnosis. A low level in any area describes no disorder or illness and belongs in no medical record.
- It is not grounds for working out who answered what. If that ever happens in a team, nobody fills in the next survey honestly.
- It is not a substitute for a conversation. The report tells you where to ask; the answer belongs to the player.

What you can build on

Areas most of the team is strong in and where the squad does not diverge. A high level with a wide spread is not something to build on, because it falls apart under pressure.

Discipline, habits and recovery
Confidence and inner dialogue

Where the work is needed most

Alongside the level, what matters is whether the weakness runs evenly across the squad or is concentrated in a few players. An even weakness is a matter of culture and leadership; a concentrated one is individual work.

Nothing of the kind showed up in this profile.

Where the team splits under pressure

In these areas it is not the usual spread but two groups with a gap between them. Pressure arrives and the squad breaks into those who cope and those who do not.

Concentration and attention control
Emotion regulation and performance under pressure

What follows from it

The value is not in single areas but in their combinations. High confidence on its own is good news; high confidence next to missing safety in communication is something else entirely.

THIS BREAKS FIRST

A fault line under pressure

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WHAT THE DATA SHOWS

On handling pressure the team divides into two groups with a marked gap between them. This is not the spread every squad has; these are two different groups.

WHAT IT DOES TO THE GROUP

While the game is calm it is invisible. As soon as it matters, the squad splits: one part plays on, the other seizes up. And because they are team mates, the first part stops playing its own game and starts managing the second. The team loses twice over.

WHAT TO DO

- 1 Train under pressure, not just with pressure on the result: a time limit, an audience, a consequence for a mistake. Otherwise the line never shows and cannot be worked with.
- 2 In tense passages simplify the task for the part of the team that seizes up. Not less responsibility, but fewer decisions.
- 3 Pair players on the pitch so that two from the same side of the line are not next to each other.

WHAT NOT TO DO

Do not give the whole team the same pre-match routine. What tunes one half up shuts the other half down.

A fault line in attention

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WHAT THE DATA SHOWS

On attention control the team divides into two groups with a marked gap between them. One part has a procedure for getting back into the match. The other relies on simply concentrating harder.

WHAT IT DOES TO THE GROUP

You will not see it in practice, because there both groups hold attention fine. The difference shows where willpower runs out: in the second half of matches, on the second day of a tournament, after a long delay. There the group without a procedure loses whole runs of points after a single error, because trying to concentrate harder turns attention inward, onto their own head, and deepens the problem. And because both groups train the same way, the session develops one group's attention and merely confirms to the other that they cannot do it.

WHAT TO DO

- 1 Find out who belongs to which group from behaviour, not from a questionnaire: watch what a player does in the first three seconds after an error. Whoever has a procedure does it the same way every time.
- 2 Give the group without a procedure one between-points routine and rehearse it to automaticity before you start anything else. A routine is not superstition; it replaces decision-making at the moment when there is no capacity to decide.
- 3 Train with deliberate interference and split the load. The group with a procedure can take more interference; the group without one first needs quiet for the routine to take hold at all.
- 4 Measure recovery time after an error in number of points and show it to the players. It is the only number in this area they can see for themselves, and the gap between the groups closes on it sooner than anywhere else.

WHAT NOT TO DO

Do not tell the whole team to concentrate harder. It adds nothing for the group with a procedure, and it takes away the last thing the other group has, because concentrating harder is precisely what costs them their attention.

The seven areas in detail

For each area you get what it measures, where the team stands, what the shape of the distribution means and what can be done about it. The order follows the structure of the survey, not importance.

Identity and inner motivation

level 66 spread ± 13

Lowest player 53, highest 92.

Distribution across the squad: stabilising 3 strong 2 elite 1

WHAT THIS AREA MEASURES

Whether the player knows why they play this sport, and whether their sense of worth rests on something other than the most recent result. Identity decides what happens after a loss. A player whose worth rides on results does not lose a match, they lose a piece of themselves, and the following week they train to feel better rather than to get better. Across a two-year cycle this is the difference between a player who accelerates after failure and one who starts playing not to make mistakes.

WHERE THE TEAM STANDS

Most of the squad has a reason to play, but does not hold it consistently. It is visible in a good stretch and gets overwritten by results in a bad one. In practice the team absorbs one loss but a run of three starts to change it.

The squad relates to its own game in much the same way across the roster. It can be addressed collectively and worked on collectively.

Confidence and inner dialogue

level 65 spread ± 11

Lowest player 45, highest 77.

Distribution across the squad: stabilising 2 strong 4

WHAT THIS AREA MEASURES

How much the player trusts their own game, and how they speak to themselves when it goes wrong. These are two different things and in a squad they often diverge. Confidence decides whether a player plays their own game in a decisive rally or the safe one. Inner dialogue decides how long the return takes after an error. A player who berates themselves after a mistake loses the next two or three points as well, no matter how complete their technique is.

WHERE THE TEAM STANDS

Confidence is there but it is tied to form. After a good week there is plenty, after a bad one it is gone. The team plays in an amplitude: two rounds above its level, two below it.

Confidence is spread evenly across the squad, so shared preparation makes sense.

Concentration and attention control

level 63 spread ± 17

the team splits Lowest player 29, highest 77.

Distribution across the squad: priority 1 stabilising 1 strong 4

WHAT THIS AREA MEASURES

The ability to hold attention where it belongs and, above all, to bring it back when it wanders. Not concentration as a trait, but refocusing as a skill. Attention drifts for everyone, constantly. What separates players is not whether their mind wanders but how quickly they notice and what they do next. That interval is what separates one lost rally from a lost set.

WHERE THE TEAM STANDS

The team holds attention as long as everything goes to plan. As soon as something unexpected arrives, a rain delay, a long break, a loud opponent, the return takes too long.

Half the team has routines and half has none. The gap shows in the second half of matches and on the later days of a tournament, not in practice.

Emotion regulation and performance under pressure

level 58 spread ± 20

the team splits **Lowest player 25, highest 77.**

Distribution across the squad: priority 1 stabilising 2 strong 3

WHAT THIS AREA MEASURES

What happens to a player under pressure: whether they notice what their body is doing, whether they can do anything about it, and whether they read a big match as an opportunity or a threat. The body responds to pressure before the mind notices. A player who cannot read the signals interprets a raised heart rate as fear and starts playing to make it end. A player who can read them gets information and time to act. This is the area where close matches are decided.

WHERE THE TEAM STANDS

The team handles pressure up to a point. Past it, the game simplifies and decisions slow down. That threshold can be moved, but only by training under real pressure, not by talking about it.

This is the most serious shape a team can have. While the match is calm it is invisible; as soon as it matters, the squad divides and the first half stops playing and starts managing the second. The team loses twice.

Resilience and growth mindset

level 71 spread ± 15

Lowest player 51, highest 96.

Distribution across the squad: stabilising 2 strong 3 elite 1

WHAT THIS AREA MEASURES

Whether the player believes ability can be developed, and what they do after failure: push harder or withdraw. Beliefs about improvability decide what a player does with a hard session. Someone who believes ability grows treats difficulty as the route; someone who does not treats it as proof they lack the talent, and starts avoiding situations where that would be visible.

WHERE THE TEAM STANDS

The team treats difficulty as part of the job. It can absorb demanding training without needing constant reassurance that it is working.

The squad approaches difficulty similarly, so it can be built on collectively.

Discipline, habits and recovery

level 73 spread ± 5

Lowest player 65, highest 78.

Distribution across the squad: strong 6

WHAT THIS AREA MEASURES

Whether the team does what it is supposed to do when it does not feel like it, and whether it allows itself to recover. Habits and rest together, because neither makes sense without the other. Discipline without recovery is not a virtue, it is a trajectory towards injury and a drop in the second half of the season. In college sport, where academic load stacks on top of training load, insufficient sleep is the single most common cause of performance decline, and the one that never shows up on the stat sheet.

WHERE THE TEAM STANDS

The team has its habits under control. This is an area to lean on while harder work goes on elsewhere.

Habits sit at a similar level across the squad, so shared rules work.

someone stands apart Lowest player 30, highest 96.

Distribution across the squad: priority 1 strong 4 elite 1

WHAT THIS AREA MEASURES

What the environment is like: whether an uncomfortable thing can be said out loud, whether players can ask for help, and whether they have someone to lean on. The environment decides whether a problem gets addressed on the day it appears or three weeks later when it has turned into something else. A team where the uncomfortable thing goes unsaid will not regroup in the closing minutes, because nobody starts. From the outside it looks calm and united.

WHERE THE TEAM STANDS

This team has an environment where things can be said. It is the strongest asset a squad can hold, because it speeds up the resolution of everything else.

One player experiences this team very differently from everyone else. With transfers, freshmen and players returning from injury this is common and it does not resolve on its own. It is not a team-meeting matter; it is one conversation, and you are the one who starts it.

WHAT TO DO ABOUT IT

- 1 Install a short regular format for talking about what is not working, and keep it separate from performance review. Without a separate place, the uncomfortable thing never gets said.
- 2 Respond to the first piece of bad news in a way the others can see. Culture is set by that single moment, not by a statement.
- 3 With new players, players returning from injury and players out of the lineup, book the conversation yourself instead of waiting for them. The people who need help most ask for it least.

HOW YOU WILL KNOW IT IS MOVING

- Problems arrive earlier and smaller than you are used to.
- Someone who normally stays quiet speaks up, and nothing bad happens to them.

A twelve-week plan

Three phases of four weeks. The order is not arbitrary: it starts with whatever most constrains everything else and ends with consolidation. Doing it all at once does not work, because a team cannot change more than one thing in one block.

WEEKS 1 TO 4

EMOTION REGULATION AND PERFORMANCE UNDER PRESSURE

Remove what blocks

WHY THIS FIRST

The team divides into two groups in Emotion regulation and performance under pressure. While that lasts there is no point introducing anything squad-wide, because each group needs something different. That is why this comes first.

WHAT TO DO

- 1 Train under pressure, not with pressure on the result. Time limits, an audience, a consequence for an error, an uneven start. Without that the threshold does not move.
- 2 Teach one breathing technique until it can be used without thinking. One mastered beats five known.
- 3 Before a key match convert the goal from outcome to process: two or three concrete things to do. That shifts threat into challenge, which is a measurable difference in physiology, not a figure of speech.

HOW YOU WILL KNOW IT IS WORKING

- The gap between practice level and big-match level narrows.

- After a match players can describe what they felt, not only how it finished.

WEEKS 5 TO 8

CONCENTRATION AND ATTENTION CONTROL

Build the skill

WHY THIS FIRST

Concentration and attention control is the lowest area in the profile. While it sits this low it holds back areas that look healthy.

WHAT TO DO

- 1 Install one fixed routine between points or between passages of play and rehearse it to automaticity. A routine is not superstition; it is a trigger that replaces decision-making at the moment when there is no capacity to decide.
- 2 Train with deliberate interference: noise, spectators, comments from outside, changed conditions. Attention trained in silence does not survive noise.
- 3 Teach players to name where their attention went in a single word. Naming shortens the return far more than trying not to think about it.

HOW YOU WILL KNOW IT IS WORKING

- Runs of lost points following a single error get shorter.
- Players hold their level into the second half of matches and the second day of an event.

WEEKS 9 TO 12

CONCENTRATION AND ATTENTION CONTROL

Consolidate under load

WHY THIS FIRST

The last four weeks belong to load: what was built gets tested in live conditions. For Concentration and attention control that means deliberately adding pressure, not easing it. Discipline, habits and recovery is the strongest thing this team has. In the third phase, lean on it: a skill built in phase two holds where something already works.

WHAT TO DO

- 1 Install one fixed routine between points or between passages of play and rehearse it to automaticity. A routine is not superstition; it is a trigger that replaces decision-making at the moment when there is no capacity to decide.
- 2 Train with deliberate interference: noise, spectators, comments from outside, changed conditions. Attention trained in silence does not survive noise.
- 3 Teach players to name where their attention went in a single word. Naming shortens the return far more than trying not to think about it.

HOW YOU WILL KNOW IT IS WORKING

- Runs of lost points following a single error get shorter.
- Players hold their level into the second half of matches and the second day of an event.

The plan derives from the profile, not from your season. Check it against the calendar: if week four lands on the peak of the season or on exams, move the phases rather than compressing them.

Individual conversations

The report shows you where to ask. The answer belongs to the player and you will not reach it without a conversation. Below are questions for each area; treat them as an opening, not a questionnaire.

- Do not ask about survey results and do not say that is where this comes from. The players did not share them with you, and mentioning them closes the conversation.

- Ask openly and let the silence sit. The first answer tends to be polite, the second true.
- One conversation, one area. Someone given four questions from four areas answers none of them.
- Run the conversation yourself, not through an assistant or a captain. Making the time for it is half of its effect.
- Finish by agreeing on one concrete thing before next time. A conversation without a conclusion repeats itself a month later unchanged.

QUESTIONS BY AREA

Identity and inner motivation

- What would you miss about this sport if you stopped tomorrow?
- When did you last enjoy playing regardless of the result?

Confidence and inner dialogue

- What do you say to yourself immediately after a mistake?
- When did you last play the shot you actually wanted in a big moment?

Concentration and attention control

- Where does your mind go most often when it matters?
- What exactly do you do between points?

Emotion regulation and performance under pressure

- How do you know pressure is coming before the match even starts?
- What helps you in those moments, and what have you tried that does not?

Resilience and growth mindset

- What is the last thing you got better at, and how long did it take?
- What do you do when something has not worked for three weeks running?

Discipline, habits and recovery

- How many hours did you actually sleep this week?
- What is the first thing to fall out of your routine during exams?

Relationships, communication and environment

- Who would you go to if something was wrong, and would you actually go?
- What does nobody in this team say out loud even though everyone knows it?

Boundaries of use

This report came out of answers the players gave you on the understanding that you would not see them. The rules below are not a formality; they are the conditions under which the data stays truthful next time.

- Do not pass this report outside the coaching staff and do not file it in player records.
- Do not try to work out who answered what, and do not signal that you could.
- Talk to the team about the team. Never in the form “one of you”.
- When few surveys have come back, treat the profile as indicative and say so when you talk about it.
- Repeat the measurement after three months at the earliest. Sooner than that, all you change is what the squad remembers answering.